

Cubs Practice Plan — Defensive Decisions & Responsibilities

Tuesday | 6:30–8:00 PM | Davis Park Field 1

6:30–6:40 — Purposeful Catch

Goal: Accurate throws and catches — *playing catch is practice, not just warm-up.*

- Keep players relatively close; don't let pairs continually drift apart.
- Coaches actively monitor and correct.
- Finish: **10 consecutive clean throws/catches** per pair.

6:40–7:05 — Live Infield + Baserunning

Goal: Know when to **THROW vs. HOLD** and where to go when the ball is hit.

Charlie hits/rolls balls with runners live.

Defensive emphasis:

- **STOP IT → LOOK → DECIDE**
- No play? **HOLD THE BALL.**
- SS/2B: one fields → **the other covers 2B.**
- RF backs up throws to **1B.**
- LF backs up throws to **3B.**
- Pitcher backs up **home.**
- **Nobody stands and watches.**

Baserunning emphasis:

- Eyes on base coaches.
- Listen to **GO / STOP / BACK.**
- Run through 1B.
- **STOMP HOME PLATE!**

7:05–7:25 — Defensive Responsibility Drill

Goal: Every player understands: **BALL — BASE — BACKUP.**

Charlie puts balls into different areas. Keith periodically calls **FREEZE!**

Ask players:

- Where should you be?
- Who has 2B?
- Who is backing up 1B/3B/home?
- Should we throw or hold?

Reset quickly and repeat. Lots of reps, minimal lectures.

7:25–7:55 — Live Coach-Pitch Scrimmage

Goal: Apply everything at game speed.

- Charlie pitches from game distance.
- Live hitting + baserunning + full defense.
- Before pitch: **“Know your job.”**
- Coaches avoid over-instructing during the play.
- Corrections afterward are **brief, quiet and instructional**.
- Create aggressive baserunning situations to force **throw/hold decisions**.

7:55–8:00 — Flame Ball Challenge

Finish with: **Respect. Effort. STOP IT → LOOK → DECIDE.**

Coaching Responsibilities

Coach	Practice Responsibility	Game Responsibility
Keith	Defensive coordinator — roam, control situations, freeze/correct plays	Head coach / primary defensive communication
Joey	1B side — 1B positioning, RF backup, throws to first	1B Coach
Jack	3B side — 3B positioning, LF backup, throws to third/home	3B Coach
Charlie	Ball placement / pitching — hit/roll balls, P/C responsibilities	Pitching
Josh	Baserunners / middle IF — runners, SS/2B coverage	Dugout / batting order